



Scottish Graduate School of Social Science

Sgoil Cheumnaichean Saidheans
Sòisealta na h-Alba

Practical Computational Methods for Social Scientists

7, 13-14 March 2025

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Computational methods are transforming research practice across the disciplines. For social scientists these methods offer a number of valuable opportunities, including creating new datasets from digital sources; unearthing new insights and avenues for research from existing data sources; and improving the accuracy and efficiency of fundamental research activities.

In this three-day course you will learn how to apply computational methods for the collection, management and analysis of text data. Using Python and R, you will develop skills in collecting data from the web; preparing textual data for computational analysis; and core methods of text data analysis (e.g., sentiment analysis, topic modelling).

Programme

Day 2

10:00 – 10:10	Welcome
10:10 – 11:00	Lecture 1 – Fundamentals of text analysis
11:00 – 11:15	Break



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11:15 – 11:30	Lecture 2 – Preprocessing text data
11:30 – 12:30	Practical 1 – Preprocessing text data
12:30 – 13:30	Lunch
13:30 – 14:00	Lecture 3 – Fundamental techniques of text analysis
14:00 – 14:30	Practical 2 – Fundamental techniques of text analysis
14:30 – 14:45	Break
14:45 – 15:30	Practical 2 – Fundamental techniques of text analysis
15:30 – 16:00	Next steps

Day 3

10:00 – 10:10	Welcome
10:10 – 11:00	Lecture 1 – Supervised and unsupervised approaches to text analysis
11:00 – 11:15	Break
11:15 – 12:30	Practical 1 – Supervised and unsupervised approaches to text analysis
12:30 – 13:30	Lunch
13:30 – 15:30	Text analysis challenge
15:30 – 16:00	Wrapping up